

Adobe University Hackathon 2026

Case 04 | StackPilot (B2B SaaS)

Devtools SaaS cited less than open-source alternatives

Industry: B2B SaaS / Developer tools | Theme: Speak to Agents - Brand Visibility

Practice paper | Timebox 45:00 | Suggested: read 5 | Q1-Q4 as marked | buffer 2

Unofficial - for team practice only. Official Round 2 may differ.

Scenario

StackPilot is a paid workflow automation tool for engineering teams (CI helpers + release checklists). Docs SEO is good. PLG trials are okay from Google.

When developers ask AI 'best CI release checklist tool', 'alternative to manual release notes', or 'automate PR release hygiene', answers push open-source GitHub Actions templates or Competitor Shiply. StackPilot appears late, described as 'enterprise-only' (false - they have a free tier).

Case facts / data

- Mention 22%, citation 9%, position ~3.2. Shiply mention 58%, citation 40%.
- Shiply wins via public comparison tables, GitHub READMEs, and Hashnode tutorials that LLMs cite.
- StackPilot docs are gated behind login for advanced pages; AI bots get redirect loops.
- Pricing page is accurate but FAQ is salesy. No neutral 'when NOT to use StackPilot' page.
- Agentic traffic strong on /docs/getting-started, weak on /docs/integrations/* (many 401s).
- G2/Capterra reviews exist but are sparse vs Shiply. Wikipedia: none.
- Losing cluster: 'open source vs paid release automation'. Winning cluster: branded troubleshooting prompts.

Questions

Question 1 (8-10 min)

Why do LLMs currently prefer Shiply/open-source narratives over StackPilot? Separate crawl access issues from authority/earned-media issues.

Question 2 (8-10 min)

Propose a 'citation bait' content set developers (and agents) would trust - without sounding like ads. List 4 assets and the prompt each should win.

Question 3 (8-10 min)

Should StackPilot ungated advanced docs for AI bots only (edge variant) while keeping human login? Debate tradeoffs (security, SEO, GEO, support load) and recommend a decision.

Question 4 (8-10 min)

Design an executive dashboard with 4 metrics that connect AI visibility to pipeline (trials/SQLs). For each metric, state the decision it drives.

Answer frame (use on every question)

- One-line bottom line first
- 2-3 causes tied to case facts (do not invent numbers)
- Prioritized actions: quick wins vs later bets
- Metrics / how you know it worked
- Optional one-line Adobe / agent angle if it fits

Judged on: analytical thinking, strategic approach, actionable insights. Write like a sharp student analyst under time pressure - specific, not buzzwordy.

Team tip: attempt alone under timer, then compare notes. Focus debate on prioritization and metrics - not who wrote longer answers.